

Strong Years program

Grip & Hands



Hand mobility, grip and forearm strength for jars, bags, doors and hobbies.

12 weeks · four levels · every session scripted.

Chang Yin & Sun Yoon

Chang Yin and Sun Yoon are AI characters created by a team of people. Their life story is fiction. The exercises and recipes are built on published research for older adults (sources in the back). This is education, not medical advice. Check with your doctor before starting new exercise.

Grip & Hands: how it works

Chang Yin

I'm Chang. AI character. Twelve weeks, one program, done properly. Hand mobility, grip and forearm strength for jars, bags, doors and hobbies.

A little more, slowly. That's the whole method.

Who it's for. Adults 60+ who want stronger, more capable hands, including people with everyday hand stiffness. It trains the hands you have; it doesn't change arthritis itself.

Ask your doctor first if: A hot, red, swollen finger joint; new numbness or tingling that's getting worse; hand or wrist surgery or a fracture in the last few months: ask your doctor or hand therapist first.

What you need. A hand towel, a soft ball or rolled sock, thick rubber bands, a paperback, water bottles, a jar with a lid, grocery bags. Optional: an inexpensive hand-grip dynamometer.

Every day: Stop if you feel chest pain or pressure, dizziness, unusual shortness of breath, or sharp pain. Chest pain, face drooping, arm weakness or trouble speaking? Call 911 now. Pain rule (E41): Mild discomfort up to 3 out of 10 is okay if it settles by tomorrow. Sharper, or worse the next day: back off and ask your doctor or physical therapist.

Your week

Mon: strength · Tue: program session A · Wed: balance · Thu: strength · Fri: program session B · Sat: walk-and-talk · Sun: rest + stretch. Program sessions are marked in **bold** in the plan; the other days use your Strong Years Daily Practice sessions (DP numbers).

Every morning: a 2-minute hand routine: 5 rounds of fist-flat-hook and 2 rounds of thumb touches each hand.

How it progresses

Three 4-week phases: **Foundation** (weeks 1–4, A1/B1), **Build** (weeks 5–8, A2/B2) and **Strengthen** (weeks 9–12, A3/B3).

Week in each phase	Rule
1st	Doses as written in the session. Learn the moves. Stop each set with one or two good reps left in the tank.
2nd	Add 1–2 reps per set (never past 12). Holds up 5 seconds (never past 30).
3rd	Where every rep felt easy two sessions in a row, use the Harder version or a heavier jug. Otherwise repeat week 2.
4th (easy week)	Easy week: same moves, one set fewer. Then do your checkpoint at the weekend.

Levels. Every session has four versions: Rebuild (chair-based), Steady, Strong and Iron. Move up only when every rep felt easy two sessions in a row. Move down any day. **Advanced** doses are never a starting point.

The 12-week plan

Week	Phase	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
1	Foundation	DP01	GRP-A1	DP03	DP04	GRP-B1	DP06	DP07
2	Foundation	DP04	GRP-A1	DP10	DP08	GRP-B1	DP13	DP14
3	Foundation	DP08	GRP-A1	DP17	DP11	GRP-B1	DP20	DP21
4 ★	Foundation	DP11	GRP-A1	DP24	DP15	GRP-B1	DP27	DP28
5	Build	DP15	GRP-A2	DP03	DP18	GRP-B2	DP06	DP07
6	Build	DP18	GRP-A2	DP10	DP22	GRP-B2	DP13	DP14
7	Build	DP22	GRP-A2	DP17	DP25	GRP-B2	DP20	DP21
8 ★	Build	DP25	GRP-A2	DP24	DP29	GRP-B2	DP27	DP28
9	Strengthen	DP29	GRP-A3	DP03	DP01	GRP-B3	DP06	DP07
10	Strengthen	DP01	GRP-A3	DP10	DP04	GRP-B3	DP13	DP14
11	Strengthen	DP04	GRP-A3	DP17	DP08	GRP-B3	DP20	DP21
12 ★	Strengthen	DP08	GRP-A3	DP24	DP11	GRP-B3	DP27	DP28

★ = easy week, then checkpoint. **Bold** = program session. DP = Daily Practice session number (sessions.json).

Red flags: Not for exercise. For your doctor, today: chest pain or pressure; fainting; sudden weakness or numbness in the face, arm or leg; trouble speaking; a sudden severe headache; new confusion; one calf that is swollen, red and painful; a hot, swollen joint; night pain that wakes you and doesn't change with position; fever with back pain; loss of bladder or bowel control or numbness in the saddle area; a fall where you hit your head (especially on blood thinners). Chest pain, face drooping, arm weakness or trouble speaking? Call 911 now.

Your checkpoints

Start, then the end of weeks 4, 8 and 12. Same chair, same shoes, same time of day. These are fitness checks from published research, **not medical tests**.

Checkpoint	How	Start	Week 4	Week 8	Week 12
Jar test (self-rating)	Opening a new, sealed jar: easily / with effort / need a tool / no				
Book pinch hold (E07)	Seconds holding a paperback by the spine, up to 30, each hand				
Two-bag carry (E07)	Seconds carrying two bags or jugs, up to 60				
30-second arm curl (E49)	Full curls, same weight each time				
Hand stiffness (E59, E41)	Finger stiffness 0–10 on waking; hand pain 0–10 after the session (pain rule)				
Grip (optional) (E06)	Dynamometer, best of 2, each hand. Under 27 kg (men) or 16 kg (women) is a screening sign worth mentioning to your doctor				

The program sessions

Full follow-along scripts for the six program sessions. The same content is in programs.json for the app and video pipeline.

GRP-A1 • Phase 1 (Foundation): Hands awake

Type	Length	Set	Wardrobe	Voices
Grip & Hands program	10:00	SET-TABLE	C-CASUAL	Chang

On screen the whole session: the "AI character" corner tag. In the first 30 seconds and before each hard block: "Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain."

Gentle-day swaps (the sore knee / sore back / low energy button): **Sore knee:** Use the Rebuild version of any standing leg move; skip floor practice and stairs today. **Sore back:** Seated versions of hinges and carries; keep every bend long-backed. **Low energy:** Do the warm-up, the first two blocks and the cool-down.

Run of show

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
0:00–0:35	Welcome	All levels together			
0:35–1:05	Shoulder rolls	6 rolls	8 rolls	8 rolls	8 rolls + circles
1:05–1:45	Prayer and wrist stretch	10 seconds, twice	20 seconds, twice	20 seconds, twice	20 seconds, twice
1:45–2:55	Fist, flat, hook	5 rounds each hand, small	8 rounds each hand	10 rounds each hand	10 rounds, 3-second holds

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
2:55–3:55	Thumb touches	2 rounds each hand, pads	3 rounds each hand	4 rounds each hand	4 rounds, 2-second press
3:55–4:55	Finger spreads	6 each hand, no band	8 each hand	10 each hand, band	12 each hand, band
4:55–5:55	Soft ball squeeze	6 each hand, sock	8 each hand	10 each hand, 5-second squeeze	12 each hand, firmer ball
5:55–7:05	Wrist curls Wrist curls with a bottle	8 up + 8 down each hand, no weight	10 up + 10 down, bottle	12 up + 12 down, bottle	12 up + 12 down, half-gallon jug
7:05–8:05	Jar lid practice	5 each hand, loose lid	6 each hand	8 each hand	8 each hand, rubber band on lid
8:05–8:55	Towel wring Towel wring (grip)	2 each way, gentle	3 each way	3 each way	4 each way, damp towel
8:55–9:35	Cyclic sighing	40 seconds	40 seconds	40 seconds	40 seconds
9:35–10:00	Close	All levels together			

Script

0:00–0:35 • Welcome

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:00	Chang	Grip and Hands. Phase one: wake the hands up.	Grip & Hands · A1

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:10	Chang	Hand exercise may help a little with stiffness and hand use. Small, honest effects in the research.	Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain
0:17	Chang	Hand pain rule: mild ache up to three out of ten that settles by tomorrow is okay. A hot, swollen joint is for your doctor.	Study: 7 trials, 534 people
0:24	Chang	Chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain: stop, sit, and call your doctor.	

0:35–1:05 • Shoulder rolls

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:35	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Shoulder rolls
0:42	Chang	Lift your shoulders up toward your ears.	Easier: Just shrug and let go
0:47	Chang	Big, slow circles, backward.	
0:52	Chang	Let your arms hang heavy.	
0:57	Chang	Breathe in as you lift, out as you roll down.	

Cues: Big, slow circles, backward. Let your arms hang heavy. **Easier:** Just shrug up and let go. **Harder:** Add arm circles: small circles out to the sides, forward and back.

1:05–1:45 • Prayer and wrist stretch

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:05	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Prayer and wrist stretch

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:14	Chang	Press your palms together in front of your chest.	Easier: Smaller stretch, 10 s
1:20	Chang	Gentle stretch only.	
1:27	Chang	Shoulders down.	
1:33	Chang	Breathe slowly.	

Cues: Gentle stretch only. Shoulders down. **Easier:** Smaller stretch, 10 seconds. **Harder:** Hold 20 seconds.

Safety callouts: Carpal tunnel symptoms (numb, tingling fingers) that get worse: skip it and tell your doctor.

1:45–2:55 • Fist, flat, hook

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:45	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Fist, flat, hook
1:59	Chang	Make a gentle fist, thumb outside.	Easier: Smaller movements
2:10	Chang	Gentle fist, not a squeeze.	
2:21	Chang	Move slowly through each shape.	
2:32	Chang	Breathe normally.	

Cues: Gentle fist, not a squeeze. Move slowly through each shape. **Easier:** Smaller movements, fewer reps. **Harder:** Hold each shape for 3 seconds.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis: stay in the comfortable range.

2:55–3:55 • Thumb touches

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
2:55	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Thumb touches
3:07	Chang	Touch your thumb to the tip of each finger, one at a time, making an O.	Easier: Finger pads, not tips
3:17	Chang	Round O shapes.	
3:26	Chang	Slow and exact.	
3:36	Chang	Breathe normally.	

Cues: Round O shapes. Slow and exact. **Easier:** Touch the pad of each finger instead of the tip. **Harder:** Press each touch gently for 2 seconds.

3:55–4:55 • Finger spreads

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
3:55	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Finger spreads
4:07	Chang	Spread all five fingers as wide as comfortable.	Easier: Smaller spread, no band
4:17	Chang	Spread, don't force.	
4:26	Chang	Slow.	
4:36	Chang	Breathe normally.	

Cues: Spread, don't force. Slow. **Easier:** No band, smaller spread. **Harder:** Loop a thick rubber band around the fingers and thumb and spread against it.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis: stay in the comfortable range. Mild ache that settles by tomorrow is okay; a hot, swollen joint is for your doctor.

4:55–5:55 • Soft ball squeeze

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
4:55	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Soft ball squeeze
5:07	Chang	Squeeze gently for 3 seconds.	Easier: Rolled sock, gentle
5:17	Chang	Whole hand squeezes.	
5:26	Chang	Relax all the way between reps.	
5:36	Chang	Breathe out as you squeeze.	

Cues: Whole hand squeezes. Relax all the way between reps. **Easier:** A rolled sock, gentle squeeze. **Harder:** A firmer ball, 5-second squeeze.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis: squeeze gently, never to pain above 3 out of 10.

5:55–7:05 • Wrist curls

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
5:55	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Wrist curls
6:09	Chang	Curl your wrist up.	Easier: Empty bottle
6:20	Chang	Forearm stays on the table.	
6:31	Chang	Slow down.	
6:42	Chang	Breathe out as you lift.	

Cues: Forearm stays on the table. Slow down. **Easier:** An empty bottle, or no weight. **Harder:** A half-full half-gallon jug.

7:05–8:05 • Jar lid practice

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
7:05	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Jar lid practice
7:17	Chang	Screw the lid on firmly.	Easier: A loose lid
7:27	Chang	Grip with the whole hand.	
7:36	Chang	Turn from the forearm, not just the fingers.	
7:46	Chang	Breathe out as you twist.	

Cues: Grip with the whole hand. Turn from the forearm, not just the fingers. **Easier:** A loose lid. **Harder:** Wrap a rubber band around the lid and screw it tighter each week.

8:05–8:55 • Towel wring

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
8:05	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Towel wring
8:16	Chang	Wring the towel hard, like squeezing out water: right hand one way, left hand the other.	Easier: Squeeze a rolled sock
8:24	Chang	Squeeze from your whole hand, not just your fingertips.	
8:32	Chang	Shoulders relaxed.	
8:40	Chang	Breathe out as you squeeze.	

Cues: Squeeze from your whole hand, not just your fingertips. Shoulders relaxed. **Easier:** Squeeze a soft ball or rolled sock instead. **Harder:** Use a damp towel, or hold each wring for five seconds.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis flaring today? Squeeze gently, or skip and do the finger spread only.

8:55–9:35 • Cyclic sighing

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
8:55	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Cyclic sighing
9:04	Chang	Breathe in through your nose.	Easier: Just slow nose breathing
9:10	Chang	Two sniffs in, one long sigh out.	
9:17	Chang	No holding at any point.	
9:23	Chang	The out-breath is always longer than the in-breath. No breath holds.	

Cues: Two sniffs in, one long sigh out. No holding at any point. **Easier:** Just breathe slowly through your nose, making the out-breath a little longer. **Harder:** Build up to 5 minutes.

Safety callouts: If you feel light-headed, return to normal breathing.

9:35–10:00 • Close

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
9:35	Chang	Hands are tools. We sharpen them a little every week.	
9:48	Chang	Friday: grip and carry.	

GRP-B1 · Phase 1 (Foundation): Grip and carry

Type	Length	Set	Wardrobe	Voices
Grip & Hands program	9:10	SET-GARAGE	C-TRAIN-A	Chang

On screen the whole session: the "AI character" corner tag. In the first 30 seconds and before each hard block: "Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain."

Gentle-day swaps (the sore knee / sore back / low energy button): **Sore knee:** Use the Rebuild version of any standing leg move; skip floor practice and stairs today. **Sore back:** Seated versions of hinges and carries; keep every bend long-backed. **Low energy:** Do the warm-up, the first two blocks and the cool-down.

Run of show

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
0:00–0:35	Welcome	All levels together			
0:35–1:10	Prayer and wrist stretch	10 seconds, twice	20 seconds, twice	20 seconds, twice	20 seconds, twice
1:10–1:55	Fist, flat, hook	5 rounds each hand	6 rounds each hand	8 rounds each hand	8 rounds each hand

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
1:55– 2:55	Towel wring Towel wring (grip)	3 each way, gentle	3 each way	4 each way	4 each way, damp towel
2:55– 4:05	Book pinch hold	2 × 5 seconds each hand, thin book	2 × 10 seconds each hand	3 × 15 seconds each hand	3 × 20 seconds each hand, thick book
4:05– 5:05	Curls Water-bottle curl	2 sets of 8, bottles	2 sets of 10, bottles	2 sets of 10, half-gallon jug	3 sets of 10, gallon jug
5:05– 6:15	Row One-arm jug row at the counter	<i>Seated towel pull-apart:</i> 4 pulls, 3-second squeeze	2 sets of 10 each arm	<i>Seated band row:</i> 3 sets of 10	3 sets of 12 each arm, heavy bag
6:15– 7:30	Two-hand carry Grocery carry	<i>Towel wring (grip):</i> 3 gentle wrigs each way, seated	2 × 20 seconds, one light bag	2 × 30 seconds	3 × 45 seconds, heavy
7:30– 8:10	Soft ball squeeze	6 each hand, gentle	8 each hand	8 each hand	10 each hand
8:10– 8:45	Cyclic sighing	35 seconds	35 seconds	35 seconds	35 seconds
8:45– 9:10	Close	All levels together			

Script

0:00–0:35 • Welcome

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:00	Chang	Grip and carry.	Grip & Hands · B1
0:10	Chang	In 142,861 adults in 17 countries, lower grip strength was linked with higher death rates. A link, not a cause. Grip is how you live.	Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain
0:17	Chang	Flaring joints today? Gentle versions only.	Study: 142,861 adults, 17 countries
0:24	Chang	Chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain: stop, sit, and call your doctor.	

0:35–1:10 • Prayer and wrist stretch

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:35	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Prayer and wrist stretch
0:43	Chang	Press your palms together in front of your chest.	Easier: Smaller stretch, 10 s
0:49	Chang	Gentle stretch only.	
0:54	Chang	Shoulders down.	
1:00	Chang	Breathe slowly.	

Cues: Gentle stretch only. Shoulders down. **Easier:** Smaller stretch, 10 seconds. **Harder:** Hold 20 seconds.

Safety callouts: Carpal tunnel symptoms (numb, tingling fingers) that get worse: skip it and tell your doctor.

1:10–1:55 • Fist, flat, hook

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:10	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Fist, flat, hook
1:20	Chang	Make a gentle fist, thumb outside.	Easier: Smaller movements
1:27	Chang	Gentle fist, not a squeeze.	
1:34	Chang	Move slowly through each shape.	
1:41	Chang	Breathe normally.	

Cues: Gentle fist, not a squeeze. Move slowly through each shape. **Easier:** Smaller movements, fewer reps. **Harder:** Hold each shape for 3 seconds.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis: stay in the comfortable range.

1:55–2:55 • Towel wring

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:55	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Towel wring
2:07	Chang	Wring the towel hard, like squeezing out water: right hand one way, left hand the other.	Easier: Squeeze a rolled sock
2:17	Chang	Squeeze from your whole hand, not just your fingertips.	
2:26	Chang	Shoulders relaxed.	
2:36	Chang	Breathe out as you squeeze.	

Cues: Squeeze from your whole hand, not just your fingertips. Shoulders relaxed. **Easier:** Squeeze a soft ball or rolled sock instead. **Harder:** Use a damp towel, or hold each wring for five seconds.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis flaring today? Squeeze gently, or skip and do the finger spread only.

2:55–4:05 • Book pinch hold

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
2:55	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Book pinch hold
3:09	Chang	Pinch and hold.	Easier: Thinner book, 5 seconds
3:20	Chang	Fingers straight, thumb opposite.	
3:31	Chang	Shoulders relaxed.	
3:42	Chang	Breathe normally. Count out loud.	

Cues: Fingers straight, thumb opposite. Shoulders relaxed. **Easier:** A thinner, lighter book, 5 seconds. **Harder:** A thicker book, up to 20 seconds.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis flaring today: skip it and do finger spreads.

4:05–5:05 • Curls

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
4:05	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Curls
4:17	Chang	Bend your elbows and bring the bottles toward your shoulders.	Easier: One arm, or empty bottles
4:27	Chang	Elbows stay by your sides.	
4:32	Chang	One... two... breathe out... three... slow down... four.	
4:36	Chang	No swinging.	
4:46	Chang	Breathe out as you curl up.	

Cues: Elbows stay by your sides. No swinging. **Easier:** One arm at a time, or empty bottles. **Harder:** Heavier: a half-gallon jug (about 4 pounds), then a full gallon jug (about 8 pounds), one at a time.

5:05–6:15 • Row

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
5:05	Chang	Hand on the counter. Chair behind you.	Row
5:19	Chang	Pull the jug up toward your ribs, elbow close to your body.	Easier: Towel pull or lighter jug
5:30	Chang	Pull with your elbow, not your hand.	
5:36	Chang	One... two... breathe out... three... slow down... four.	
5:41	Chang	Long back. Don't twist.	
5:52	Chang	Breathe out as you pull.	

Cues: Pull with your elbow, not your hand. Long back. Don't twist. **Easier:** Stand upright and pull a towel looped around a sturdy door handle (see Towel row), or use a lighter jug. **Harder:** Full gallon jug (about 8 pounds), or a bag with a few cans. Pause for one second at the top.

Safety callouts: Osteoporosis: keep the hinge small and the back long. Check the band for nicks before every use. Door must open away from you and be locked.

6:15–7:30 • Two-hand carry

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
6:15	Chang	Clear path. Walk along the counter or a hallway wall.	Two-hand carry

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
6:30	Chang	Stand tall, shoulders down.	Easier: One light bag, hand on counter
6:42	Chang	Tall, like you're proud of the groceries.	
6:54	Chang	Short, steady steps.	
7:06	Chang	Breathe steadily. You should be able to talk.	

Cues: Tall, like you're proud of the groceries. Short, steady steps. **Easier:** One light bag, and keep your free hand trailing along the counter. **Harder:** Heavier: two full gallon jugs (about 8 pounds each). Iron track: two heavier bags or kettlebells.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis flaring today? Squeeze gently, or skip and do the finger spread only. Pick up and put down with a hinge. Never round your back to lift.

7:30–8:10 • Soft ball squeeze

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
7:30	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Soft ball squeeze
7:39	Chang	Squeeze gently for 3 seconds.	Easier: Rolled sock, gentle
7:45	Chang	Whole hand squeezes.	
7:52	Chang	Relax all the way between reps.	
7:58	Chang	Breathe out as you squeeze.	

Cues: Whole hand squeezes. Relax all the way between reps. **Easier:** A rolled sock, gentle squeeze. **Harder:** A firmer ball, 5-second squeeze.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis: squeeze gently, never to pain above 3 out of 10.

8:10–8:45 • Cyclic sighing

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
8:10	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Cyclic sighing
8:18	Chang	Breathe in through your nose.	Easier: Just slow nose breathing
8:24	Chang	Two sniffs in, one long sigh out.	
8:29	Chang	No holding at any point.	
8:35	Chang	The out-breath is always longer than the in-breath. No breath holds.	

Cues: Two sniffs in, one long sigh out. No holding at any point. **Easier:** Just breathe slowly through your nose, making the out-breath a little longer. **Harder:** Build up to 5 minutes.

Safety callouts: If you feel light-headed, return to normal breathing.

8:45–9:10 • Close

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
8:45	Chang	Carry your groceries in two bags this week.	
8:58	Chang	Tuesday: hands again.	

GRP-A2 · Phase 2 (Build): Hands stronger

Type	Length	Set	Wardrobe	Voices
Grip & Hands program	9:10	SET-TABLE	C-CASUAL	Chang

On screen the whole session: the "AI character" corner tag. In the first 30 seconds and before each hard block: "Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain."

Gentle-day swaps (the sore knee / sore back / low energy button): **Sore knee:** Use the Rebuild version of any standing leg move; skip floor practice and stairs today. **Sore back:** Seated versions of hinges and carries; keep every bend long-backed. **Low energy:** Do the warm-up, the first two blocks and the cool-down.

Run of show

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
0:00–0:35	Welcome	All levels together			
0:35–1:15	Prayer and wrist stretch	10 seconds, twice	20 seconds, twice	20 seconds, twice	20 seconds, twice
1:15–2:05	Fist, flat, hook	6 rounds each hand	8 rounds each hand	10 rounds, 3-second holds	10 rounds, 3-second holds
2:05–3:05	Finger spreads	8 each hand, no band	10 each hand, band	12 each hand, band	12 each hand, two bands

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
3:05–3:55	Thumb touches	3 rounds, pads	4 rounds	4 rounds, 2-second press	5 rounds, 2-second press
3:55–5:05	Wrist curls Wrist curls with a bottle	10 up + 10 down, bottle	12 up + 12 down, bottle	12 up + 12 down, half-gallon jug	2 × 12 up + 12 down, half-gallon jug
5:05–6:05	Soft ball squeeze	8 each hand	10 each hand, 5-second squeeze	12 each hand, firmer ball	12 each hand, firmer ball, 5 s
6:05–7:05	Jar lid practice	6 each hand	8 each hand, rubber band	10 each hand, tighter	10 each hand, tighter
7:05–8:05	Book pinch hold	2 × 8 seconds each hand	3 × 12 seconds each hand	3 × 20 seconds each hand	3 × 20 seconds, thick book
8:05–8:45	Cyclic sighing	40 seconds	40 seconds	40 seconds	40 seconds
8:45–9:10	Close	All levels together			

Script

0:00–0:35 • Welcome

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:00	Chang	Phase two. Hands stronger.	Grip & Hands · A2
0:10	Chang	Bands on the fingers, heavier bottles, tighter lids.	Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain
0:17	Chang	Pain rule still applies.	

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:24	Chang	Chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain: stop, sit, and call your doctor.	

0:35–1:15 • Prayer and wrist stretch

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:35	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Prayer and wrist stretch
0:44	Chang	Press your palms together in front of your chest.	Easier: Smaller stretch, 10 s
0:50	Chang	Gentle stretch only.	
0:57	Chang	Shoulders down.	
1:03	Chang	Breathe slowly.	

Cues: Gentle stretch only. Shoulders down. **Easier:** Smaller stretch, 10 seconds. **Harder:** Hold 20 seconds.

Safety callouts: Carpal tunnel symptoms (numb, tingling fingers) that get worse: skip it and tell your doctor.

1:15–2:05 • Fist, flat, hook

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:15	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Fist, flat, hook
1:26	Chang	Make a gentle fist, thumb outside.	Easier: Smaller movements
1:34	Chang	Gentle fist, not a squeeze.	
1:42	Chang	Move slowly through each shape.	

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:50	Chang	Breathe normally.	

Cues: Gentle fist, not a squeeze. Move slowly through each shape. **Easier:** Smaller movements, fewer reps. **Harder:** Hold each shape for 3 seconds.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis: stay in the comfortable range.

2:05–3:05 • Finger spreads

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
2:05	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Finger spreads
2:17	Chang	Spread all five fingers as wide as comfortable.	Easier: Smaller spread, no band
2:27	Chang	Spread, don't force.	
2:36	Chang	Slow.	
2:46	Chang	Breathe normally.	

Cues: Spread, don't force. Slow. **Easier:** No band, smaller spread. **Harder:** Loop a thick rubber band around the fingers and thumb and spread against it.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis: stay in the comfortable range. Mild ache that settles by tomorrow is okay; a hot, swollen joint is for your doctor.

3:05–3:55 • Thumb touches

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
3:05	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Thumb touches
3:16	Chang	Touch your thumb to the tip of each finger, one at a time, making an O.	Easier: Finger pads, not tips

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
3:24	Chang	Round O shapes.	
3:32	Chang	Slow and exact.	
3:40	Chang	Breathe normally.	

Cues: Round O shapes. Slow and exact. **Easier:** Touch the pad of each finger instead of the tip. **Harder:** Press each touch gently for 2 seconds.

3:55–5:05 • Wrist curls

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
3:55	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Wrist curls
4:09	Chang	Curl your wrist up.	Easier: Empty bottle
4:20	Chang	Forearm stays on the table.	
4:31	Chang	Slow down.	
4:42	Chang	Breathe out as you lift.	

Cues: Forearm stays on the table. Slow down. **Easier:** An empty bottle, or no weight. **Harder:** A half-full half-gallon jug.

5:05–6:05 • Soft ball squeeze

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
5:05	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Soft ball squeeze
5:17	Chang	Squeeze gently for 3 seconds.	Easier: Rolled sock, gentle
5:27	Chang	Whole hand squeezes.	
5:36	Chang	Relax all the way between reps.	

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
5:46	Chang	Breathe out as you squeeze.	

Cues: Whole hand squeezes. Relax all the way between reps. **Easier:** A rolled sock, gentle squeeze. **Harder:** A firmer ball, 5-second squeeze.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis: squeeze gently, never to pain above 3 out of 10.

6:05–7:05 • Jar lid practice

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
6:05	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Jar lid practice
6:17	Chang	Screw the lid on firmly.	Easier: A loose lid
6:27	Chang	Grip with the whole hand.	
6:36	Chang	Turn from the forearm, not just the fingers.	
6:46	Chang	Breathe out as you twist.	

Cues: Grip with the whole hand. Turn from the forearm, not just the fingers. **Easier:** A loose lid. **Harder:** Wrap a rubber band around the lid and screw it tighter each week.

7:05–8:05 • Book pinch hold

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
7:05	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Book pinch hold
7:17	Chang	Pinch and hold.	Easier: Thinner book, 5 seconds
7:27	Chang	Fingers straight, thumb opposite.	
7:36	Chang	Shoulders relaxed.	

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
7:46	Chang	Breathe normally. Count out loud.	

Cues: Fingers straight, thumb opposite. Shoulders relaxed. **Easier:** A thinner, lighter book, 5 seconds. **Harder:** A thicker book, up to 20 seconds.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis flaring today: skip it and do finger spreads.

8:05–8:45 • Cyclic sighing

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
8:05	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Cyclic sighing
8:14	Chang	Breathe in through your nose.	Easier: Just slow nose breathing
8:20	Chang	Two sniffs in, one long sigh out.	
8:27	Chang	No holding at any point.	
8:33	Chang	The out-breath is always longer than the in-breath. No breath holds.	

Cues: Two sniffs in, one long sigh out. No holding at any point. **Easier:** Just breathe slowly through your nose, making the out-breath a little longer. **Harder:** Build up to 5 minutes.

Safety callouts: If you feel light-headed, return to normal breathing.

8:45–9:10 • Close

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
8:45	Chang	Try a real jar this week. Tell me.	
8:58	Chang	Friday: grip and carry.	

GRP-B2 · Phase 2 (Build): Heavier carries

Type	Length	Set	Wardrobe	Voices
Grip & Hands program	9:00	SET-GARAGE	C-TRAIN-A	Chang

On screen the whole session: the "AI character" corner tag. In the first 30 seconds and before each hard block: "Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain."

Gentle-day swaps (the sore knee / sore back / low energy button): **Sore knee:** Use the Rebuild version of any standing leg move; skip floor practice and stairs today. **Sore back:** Seated versions of hinges and carries; keep every bend long-backed. **Low energy:** Do the warm-up, the first two blocks and the cool-down.

Run of show

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
0:00–0:35	Welcome	All levels together			
0:35–1:20	Fist, flat, hook	5 rounds each hand	6 rounds each hand	8 rounds each hand	8 rounds each hand
1:20–1:50	Shoulder rolls	6 rolls	8 rolls	8 rolls + circles	8 rolls + circles

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
1:50–2:45	Towel wring Towel wring (grip)	3 each way	4 each way	4 each way, damp	5 each way, damp
2:45–4:00	One-side carry	<i>Towel wring (grip):</i> 3 gentle wrings, seated	2 × 20 seconds each side	2 × 30 seconds each side	3 × 40 seconds each side
4:00–5:15	Two-hand carry Grocery carry	<i>Soft ball squeeze:</i> 10 each hand	2 × 30 seconds	3 × 40 seconds	3 × 60 seconds, heavy
5:15–6:25	Row Seated band row	2 sets of 10, close to the door	3 sets of 10	3 sets of 12, pause	<i>One-arm jug row at the counter:</i> 3 sets of 12 each arm, heavy bag
6:25–7:20	Curls Water-bottle curl	2 sets of 10, bottles	2 sets of 10, half-gallon jug	3 sets of 10, half-gallon jug	3 sets of 10, gallon jug
7:20–8:00	Prayer and wrist stretch	10 seconds, twice	20 seconds, twice	20 seconds, twice	20 seconds, twice
8:00–8:35	Cyclic sighing	35 seconds	35 seconds	35 seconds	35 seconds
8:35–9:00	Close	All levels together			

Script

0:00–0:35 • Welcome

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:00	Chang	Phase two. Heavier carries.	Grip & Hands · B2
0:10	Chang	Pick up with a hinge. Always.	Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain
0:17	Chang	Clear path.	
0:24	Chang	Chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain: stop, sit, and call your doctor.	

0:35–1:20 • Fist, flat, hook

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:35	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Fist, flat, hook
0:45	Chang	Make a gentle fist, thumb outside.	Easier: Smaller movements
0:52	Chang	Gentle fist, not a squeeze.	
0:59	Chang	Move slowly through each shape.	
1:06	Chang	Breathe normally.	

Cues: Gentle fist, not a squeeze. Move slowly through each shape. **Easier:** Smaller movements, fewer reps. **Harder:** Hold each shape for 3 seconds.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis: stay in the comfortable range.

1:20–1:50 • Shoulder rolls

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:20	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Shoulder rolls
1:27	Chang	Lift your shoulders up toward your ears.	Easier: Just shrug and let go
1:32	Chang	Big, slow circles, backward.	
1:37	Chang	Let your arms hang heavy.	
1:42	Chang	Breathe in as you lift, out as you roll down.	

Cues: Big, slow circles, backward. Let your arms hang heavy. **Easier:** Just shrug up and let go. **Harder:** Add arm circles: small circles out to the sides, forward and back.

1:50–2:45 • Towel wring

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:50	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Towel wring
2:01	Chang	Wring the towel hard, like squeezing out water: right hand one way, left hand the other.	Easier: Squeeze a rolled sock
2:10	Chang	Squeeze from your whole hand, not just your fingertips.	
2:19	Chang	Shoulders relaxed.	
2:28	Chang	Breathe out as you squeeze.	

Cues: Squeeze from your whole hand, not just your fingertips. Shoulders relaxed. **Easier:** Squeeze a soft ball or rolled sock instead. **Harder:** Use a damp towel, or hold each wring for five seconds.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis flaring today? Squeeze gently, or skip and do the finger spread only.

2:45–4:00 • One-side carry

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
2:45	Chang	Clear path. Free hand trails along the counter.	One-side carry
3:00	Chang	Stand tall. Don't lean away from the bag.	Easier: Lighter bag, hand on counter
3:12	Chang	Tall like a lamppost.	
3:24	Chang	Shoulders level.	
3:36	Chang	Breathe steadily. You should be able to talk.	

Cues: Tall like a lamppost. Shoulders level. **Easier:** A lighter bag, free hand on the counter the whole time. **Harder:** A heavier bag, or a longer walk.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis flaring today? Squeeze gently, or skip and do the finger spread only. Pick up and put down with a hinge. Never round your back to lift.

4:00–5:15 • Two-hand carry

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
4:00	Chang	Clear path. Walk along the counter or a hallway wall.	Two-hand carry
4:15	Chang	Stand tall, shoulders down.	Easier: One light bag, hand on counter
4:27	Chang	Tall, like you're proud of the groceries.	
4:39	Chang	Short, steady steps.	

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
4:51	Chang	Breathe steadily. You should be able to talk.	

Cues: Tall, like you're proud of the groceries. Short, steady steps. **Easier:** One light bag, and keep your free hand trailing along the counter. **Harder:** Heavier: two full gallon jugs (about 8 pounds each). Iron track: two heavier bags or kettlebells.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis: squeeze gently, never to pain above 3 out of 10. Pick up and put down with a hinge. Never round your back to lift.

5:15–6:25 • Row

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
5:15	Chang	Sit or stand with the chair behind you. Check the band first.	Row
5:29	Chang	Pull your elbows back past your ribs.	Easier: Closer to the door, or towel
5:40	Chang	Elbows close to your body.	
5:46	Chang	One... two... breathe out... three... slow down... four.	
5:51	Chang	Tall chest, shoulders down.	
6:02	Chang	Breathe out as you pull.	

Cues: Elbows close to your body. Tall chest, shoulders down. **Easier:** Sit closer to the door so the band is slacker, or do the towel pull-apart.

Harder: Scoot back for more tension, or pause 2 seconds with elbows back.

Safety callouts: Check the band for nicks before every use. Door must open away from you and be locked. Osteoporosis: keep the hinge small and the back long.

6:25–7:20 • Curls

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
6:25	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Curls
6:36	Chang	Bend your elbows and bring the bottles toward your shoulders.	Easier: One arm, or empty bottles
6:45	Chang	Elbows stay by your sides.	
6:49	Chang	One... two... breathe out... three... slow down... four.	
6:54	Chang	No swinging.	
7:03	Chang	Breathe out as you curl up.	

Cues: Elbows stay by your sides. No swinging. **Easier:** One arm at a time, or empty bottles. **Harder:** Heavier: a half-gallon jug (about 4 pounds), then a full gallon jug (about 8 pounds), one at a time.

7:20–8:00 • Prayer and wrist stretch

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
7:20	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Prayer and wrist stretch
7:29	Chang	Press your palms together in front of your chest.	Easier: Smaller stretch, 10 s
7:35	Chang	Gentle stretch only.	
7:42	Chang	Shoulders down.	

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
7:48	Chang	Breathe slowly.	

Cues: Gentle stretch only. Shoulders down. **Easier:** Smaller stretch, 10 seconds. **Harder:** Hold 20 seconds.

Safety callouts: Carpal tunnel symptoms (numb, tingling fingers) that get worse: skip it and tell your doctor.

8:00–8:35 • Cyclic sighing

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
8:00	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Cyclic sighing
8:08	Chang	Breathe in through your nose.	Easier: Just slow nose breathing
8:14	Chang	Two sniffs in, one long sigh out.	
8:19	Chang	No holding at any point.	
8:25	Chang	The out-breath is always longer than the in-breath. No breath holds.	

Cues: Two sniffs in, one long sigh out. No holding at any point. **Easier:** Just breathe slowly through your nose, making the out-breath a little longer. **Harder:** Build up to 5 minutes.

Safety callouts: If you feel light-headed, return to normal breathing.

8:35–9:00 • Close

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
8:35	Chang	Strong hands carry the groceries in one trip. Carefully.	

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
8:48	Chang	Checkpoint at the end of week eight.	

GRP-A3 • Phase 3 (Strengthen): Hands for hobbies

Type	Length	Set	Wardrobe	Voices
Grip & Hands program	9:05	SET-TABLE	C-CASUAL	Chang

On screen the whole session: the "AI character" corner tag. In the first 30 seconds and before each hard block: "Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain."

Gentle-day swaps (the sore knee / sore back / low energy button): **Sore knee:** Use the Rebuild version of any standing leg move; skip floor practice and stairs today. **Sore back:** Seated versions of hinges and carries; keep every bend long-backed. **Low energy:** Do the warm-up, the first two blocks and the cool-down.

Run of show

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
0:00–0:35	Welcome	All levels together			
0:35–1:15	Prayer and wrist stretch	10 seconds, twice	20 seconds, twice	20 seconds, twice	20 seconds, twice
1:15–2:10	Thumb touches	3 rounds, pads	5 rounds	5 rounds, 2-second press	6 rounds, 2-second press

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
2:10–3:05	Finger spreads	10 each hand, no band	12 each hand, band	12 each hand, two bands	12 each hand, two bands, 3 s
3:05–4:00	Fist, flat, hook	8 rounds	10 rounds, 3-second holds	12 rounds, 3-second holds	12 rounds, 3-second holds
4:00–5:10	Wrist curls Wrist curls with a bottle	12 up + 12 down, bottle	2 × 12 each way, bottle	2 × 12 each way, half-gallon jug	3 × 12 each way, half-gallon jug
5:10–6:10	Book pinch hold	3 × 10 seconds each hand	3 × 15 seconds each hand	3 × 20 seconds, thick book	3 × 30 seconds, thick book
6:10–7:05	Soft ball squeeze	10 each hand	12 each hand, 5 s	12 each hand, firmer ball, 5 s	2 × 12 each hand, firmer ball
7:05–8:00	Jar lid practice	8 each hand	10 each hand, tighter	10 each hand, tightest	12 each hand, tightest
8:00–8:40	Cyclic sighing	40 seconds	40 seconds	40 seconds	40 seconds
8:40–9:05	Close	All levels together			

Script

0:00–0:35 • Welcome

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:00	Chang	Phase three. Hands for your hobbies: gardening, knitting, cards, tools.	Grip & Hands · A3

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:10	Chang	Control and endurance.	Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain
0:17	Chang	Pain rule applies.	
0:24	Chang	Chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain: stop, sit, and call your doctor.	

0:35–1:15 • Prayer and wrist stretch

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:35	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Prayer and wrist stretch
0:44	Chang	Press your palms together in front of your chest.	Easier: Smaller stretch, 10 s
0:50	Chang	Gentle stretch only.	
0:57	Chang	Shoulders down.	
1:03	Chang	Breathe slowly.	

Cues: Gentle stretch only. Shoulders down. **Easier:** Smaller stretch, 10 seconds. **Harder:** Hold 20 seconds.

Safety callouts: Carpal tunnel symptoms (numb, tingling fingers) that get worse: skip it and tell your doctor.

1:15–2:10 • Thumb touches

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:15	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Thumb touches

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:26	Chang	Touch your thumb to the tip of each finger, one at a time, making an O.	Easier: Finger pads, not tips
1:35	Chang	Round O shapes.	
1:44	Chang	Slow and exact.	
1:53	Chang	Breathe normally.	

Cues: Round O shapes. Slow and exact. **Easier:** Touch the pad of each finger instead of the tip. **Harder:** Press each touch gently for 2 seconds.

2:10–3:05 • Finger spreads

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
2:10	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Finger spreads
2:21	Chang	Spread all five fingers as wide as comfortable.	Easier: Smaller spread, no band
2:30	Chang	Spread, don't force.	
2:39	Chang	Slow.	
2:48	Chang	Breathe normally.	

Cues: Spread, don't force. Slow. **Easier:** No band, smaller spread. **Harder:** Loop a thick rubber band around the fingers and thumb and spread against it.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis: stay in the comfortable range. Mild ache that settles by tomorrow is okay; a hot, swollen joint is for your doctor.

3:05–4:00 • Fist, flat, hook

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
3:05	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Fist, flat, hook
3:16	Chang	Make a gentle fist, thumb outside.	Easier: Smaller movements
3:25	Chang	Gentle fist, not a squeeze.	
3:34	Chang	Move slowly through each shape.	
3:43	Chang	Breathe normally.	

Cues: Gentle fist, not a squeeze. Move slowly through each shape. **Easier:** Smaller movements, fewer reps. **Harder:** Hold each shape for 3 seconds.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis: stay in the comfortable range.

4:00–5:10 • Wrist curls

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
4:00	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Wrist curls
4:14	Chang	Curl your wrist up.	Easier: Empty bottle
4:25	Chang	Forearm stays on the table.	
4:36	Chang	Slow down.	
4:47	Chang	Breathe out as you lift.	

Cues: Forearm stays on the table. Slow down. **Easier:** An empty bottle, or no weight. **Harder:** A half-full half-gallon jug.

5:10–6:10 • Book pinch hold

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
5:10	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Book pinch hold
5:22	Chang	Pinch and hold.	Easier: Thinner book, 5 seconds
5:32	Chang	Fingers straight, thumb opposite.	
5:41	Chang	Shoulders relaxed.	
5:51	Chang	Breathe normally. Count out loud.	

Cues: Fingers straight, thumb opposite. Shoulders relaxed. **Easier:** A thinner, lighter book, 5 seconds. **Harder:** A thicker book, up to 20 seconds.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis flaring today: skip it and do finger spreads.

6:10–7:05 • Soft ball squeeze

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
6:10	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Soft ball squeeze
6:21	Chang	Squeeze gently for 3 seconds.	Easier: Rolled sock, gentle
6:30	Chang	Whole hand squeezes.	
6:39	Chang	Relax all the way between reps.	
6:48	Chang	Breathe out as you squeeze.	

Cues: Whole hand squeezes. Relax all the way between reps. **Easier:** A rolled sock, gentle squeeze. **Harder:** A firmer ball, 5-second squeeze.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis: squeeze gently, never to pain above 3 out of 10.

7:05–8:00 • Jar lid practice

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
7:05	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Jar lid practice
7:16	Chang	Screw the lid on firmly.	Easier: A loose lid
7:25	Chang	Grip with the whole hand.	
7:34	Chang	Turn from the forearm, not just the fingers.	
7:43	Chang	Breathe out as you twist.	

Cues: Grip with the whole hand. Turn from the forearm, not just the fingers. **Easier:** A loose lid. **Harder:** Wrap a rubber band around the lid and screw it tighter each week.

8:00–8:40 • Cyclic sighing

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
8:00	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Cyclic sighing
8:09	Chang	Breathe in through your nose.	Easier: Just slow nose breathing
8:15	Chang	Two sniffs in, one long sigh out.	
8:22	Chang	No holding at any point.	
8:28	Chang	The out-breath is always longer than the in-breath. No breath holds.	

Cues: Two sniffs in, one long sigh out. No holding at any point. **Easier:** Just breathe slowly through your nose, making the out-breath a little longer. **Harder:** Build up to 5 minutes.

Safety callouts: If you feel light-headed, return to normal breathing.

8:40–9:05 • Close

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
8:40	Chang	Hands that open jars are hands that stay independent.	
8:53	Chang	Friday: the last carry session.	

GRP-B3 • Phase 3 (Strengthen): Strong grip

Type	Length	Set	Wardrobe	Voices
Grip & Hands program	8:55	SET-GARAGE	C-TRAIN-A	Chang

On screen the whole session: the "AI character" corner tag. In the first 30 seconds and before each hard block: "Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain."

Gentle-day swaps (the sore knee / sore back / low energy button): **Sore knee:** Use the Rebuild version of any standing leg move; skip floor practice and stairs today. **Sore back:** Seated versions of hinges and carries; keep every bend long-backed. **Low energy:** Do the warm-up, the first two blocks and the cool-down.

Run of show

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
0:00–0:35	Welcome	All levels together			
0:35–1:20	Fist, flat, hook	6 rounds each hand	8 rounds each hand	8 rounds each hand	8 rounds each hand
1:20–2:00	Towel wring Towel wring (grip)	3 each way	4 each way	4 each way, damp	5 each way, damp

Time	Segment	Rebuild	Steady	Strong	Iron
2:00–3:30	Two-hand carry Grocery carry	<i>Soft ball squeeze:</i> 12 each hand, 5-second squeeze	3 × 30 seconds, heavier	3 × 45 seconds, heavy	3 × 60 seconds, heavy
3:30–4:50	One-side carry	<i>Towel wring (grip):</i> 4 wrings each way	2 × 30 seconds each side	3 × 40 seconds each side	3 × 60 seconds each side, heavy
4:50–5:50	Book pinch hold	3 × 10 seconds	3 × 15 seconds	3 × 20 seconds, thick book	3 × 30 seconds, thick book
5:50–6:45	Curls Water-bottle curl	2 sets of 10, half-gallon jug	3 sets of 10, half-gallon jug	3 sets of 10, gallon jug	3 sets of 12, gallon jug
6:45–7:50	Row Seated band row	3 sets of 10	3 sets of 12, pause	<i>One-arm jug row at the counter:</i> 3 sets of 12 each arm, heavy bag	<i>One-arm jug row at the counter:</i> 3 sets of 12 each arm, heavier bag
7:50–8:30	Prayer and wrist stretch	10 seconds, twice	20 seconds, twice	20 seconds, twice	20 seconds, twice
8:30–8:55	Close	All levels together			

Script

0:00–0:35 • Welcome

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:00	Chang	Phase three. Strong grip.	Grip & Hands • B3

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:10	Chang	Longest carries, heaviest curls you can do with good form.	Stop if chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain
0:17	Chang	Hinge to pick up.	
0:24	Chang	Chest pain, dizziness or sharp pain: stop, sit, and call your doctor.	

0:35–1:20 • Fist, flat, hook

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
0:35	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Fist, flat, hook
0:45	Chang	Make a gentle fist, thumb outside.	Easier: Smaller movements
0:52	Chang	Gentle fist, not a squeeze.	
0:59	Chang	Move slowly through each shape.	
1:06	Chang	Breathe normally.	

Cues: Gentle fist, not a squeeze. Move slowly through each shape. **Easier:** Smaller movements, fewer reps. **Harder:** Hold each shape for 3 seconds.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis: stay in the comfortable range.

1:20–2:00 • Towel wring

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:20	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Towel wring
1:29	Chang	Wring the towel hard, like squeezing out water: right hand one way, left hand the other.	Easier: Squeeze a rolled sock

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
1:35	Chang	Squeeze from your whole hand, not just your fingertips.	
1:42	Chang	Shoulders relaxed.	
1:48	Chang	Breathe out as you squeeze.	

Cues: Squeeze from your whole hand, not just your fingertips. Shoulders relaxed. **Easier:** Squeeze a soft ball or rolled sock instead. **Harder:** Use a damp towel, or hold each wring for five seconds.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis flaring today? Squeeze gently, or skip and do the finger spread only.

2:00–3:30 • Two-hand carry

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
2:00	Chang	Clear path. Walk along the counter or a hallway wall.	Two-hand carry
2:17	Chang	Stand tall, shoulders down.	Easier: One light bag, hand on counter
2:31	Chang	Tall, like you're proud of the groceries.	
2:46	Chang	Short, steady steps.	
3:00	Chang	Breathe steadily. You should be able to talk.	

Cues: Tall, like you're proud of the groceries. Short, steady steps. **Easier:** One light bag, and keep your free hand trailing along the counter. **Harder:** Heavier: two full gallon jugs (about 8 pounds each). Iron track: two heavier bags or kettlebells.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis: squeeze gently, never to pain above 3 out of 10. Pick up and put down with a hinge. Never round your back to lift.

3:30–4:50 • One-side carry

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
3:30	Chang	Clear path. Free hand trails along the counter.	One-side carry
3:45	Chang	Stand tall. Don't lean away from the bag.	Easier: Lighter bag, hand on counter
3:58	Chang	Tall like a lamppost.	
4:11	Chang	Shoulders level.	
4:24	Chang	Breathe steadily. You should be able to talk.	

Cues: Tall like a lamppost. Shoulders level. **Easier:** A lighter bag, free hand on the counter the whole time. **Harder:** A heavier bag, or a longer walk.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis flaring today? Squeeze gently, or skip and do the finger spread only. Pick up and put down with a hinge. Never round your back to lift.

4:50–5:50 • Book pinch hold

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
4:50	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Book pinch hold
5:02	Chang	Pinch and hold.	Easier: Thinner book, 5 seconds
5:12	Chang	Fingers straight, thumb opposite.	
5:21	Chang	Shoulders relaxed.	
5:31	Chang	Breathe normally. Count out loud.	

Cues: Fingers straight, thumb opposite. Shoulders relaxed. **Easier:** A thinner, lighter book, 5 seconds. **Harder:** A thicker book, up to 20 seconds.

Safety callouts: Hand arthritis flaring today: skip it and do finger spreads.

5:50–6:45 • Curls

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
5:50	Chang	Sit tall. Chair against the wall.	Curls
6:01	Chang	Bend your elbows and bring the bottles toward your shoulders.	Easier: One arm, or empty bottles
6:10	Chang	Elbows stay by your sides.	
6:14	Chang	One... two... breathe out... three... slow down... four.	
6:19	Chang	No swinging.	
6:28	Chang	Breathe out as you curl up.	

Cues: Elbows stay by your sides. No swinging. **Easier:** One arm at a time, or empty bottles. **Harder:** Heavier: a half-gallon jug (about 4 pounds), then a full gallon jug (about 8 pounds), one at a time.

6:45–7:50 • Row

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
6:45	Chang	Sit or stand with the chair behind you. Check the band first.	Row
6:58	Chang	Pull your elbows back past your ribs.	Easier: Closer to the door, or towel
7:08	Chang	Elbows close to your body.	

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
7:14	Chang	One... two... breathe out... three... slow down... four.	
7:19	Chang	Tall chest, shoulders down.	
7:29	Chang	Breathe out as you pull.	

Cues: Elbows close to your body. Tall chest, shoulders down. **Easier:** Sit closer to the door so the band is slacker, or do the towel pull-apart.

Harder: Scoot back for more tension, or pause 2 seconds with elbows back.

Safety callouts: Check the band for nicks before every use. Door must open away from you and be locked. Osteoporosis: keep the hinge small and the back long.

7:50–8:30 • Prayer and wrist stretch

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
7:50	Chang	Sit at the table. Forearm resting on it.	Prayer and wrist stretch
7:59	Chang	Press your palms together in front of your chest.	Easier: Smaller stretch, 10 s
8:05	Chang	Gentle stretch only.	
8:12	Chang	Shoulders down.	
8:18	Chang	Breathe slowly.	

Cues: Gentle stretch only. Shoulders down. **Easier:** Smaller stretch, 10 seconds. **Harder:** Hold 20 seconds.

Safety callouts: Carpal tunnel symptoms (numb, tingling fingers) that get worse: skip it and tell your doctor.

8:30–8:55 • Close

Time	Who	Spoken	On screen
8:30	Chang	Twelve weeks of grip. Test a real jar this weekend.	
8:43	Chang	Final checkpoint this weekend.	

Where the numbers come from

Every number and health statement in this book traces to one of the entries below. They are the same evidence IDs our whole team uses (EVIDENCE.md). Grade A means a Cochrane review, a large meta-analysis or a guideline body. B means a single good trial or a small meta-analysis. C means an observational study: it shows a link, not cause and effect. D means lab, physiology or label data.

E01 (grade A). Progressive resistance training in older adults: 121 RCTs, 6,700 people, 2–3×/week. Large effect on strength (SMD 0.84), moderate-to-large effect on getting out of a chair (SMD –0.94), gait speed +0.08 m/s, less osteoarthritis pain. Most side effects were minor soreness or joint pain.

Source: Liu & Latham, Cochrane 2009 — https://www.cochrane.org/evidence/CD002759_progressive-resistance-strength-training-improving-physical-function-older-adults

E06 (grade A (consensus)). Sarcopenia screening cut-offs (EWGSOP2): grip under 27 kg for men or under 16 kg for women, or 5 chair rises taking more than 15 s, signals "probable sarcopenia".

Source: Cruz-Jentoft et al., Age Ageing 2019 — <https://www.esceo.org/sites/esceo/files/pdf/2019%20Age%20Ageing%20EWGSOP2.pdf>

E07 (grade C). PURE study: 142,861 adults in 17 countries. Every 5 kg lower grip strength was linked with 16% higher all-cause mortality and 17% higher CV mortality. Grip predicted mortality better than systolic blood pressure.

Source: Leong et al., Lancet 2015 — [https://www.thelancet.com/journals/lancet/article/PIIS0140-6736\(14\)62000-6/abstract](https://www.thelancet.com/journals/lancet/article/PIIS0140-6736(14)62000-6/abstract) ; summary <https://www.consultant360.com/exclusives/could-grip-strength-predict-all-cause-mortality-risk>

E41 (grade B (known literature)). Pain-monitoring model: during and after exercise, pain up to about 3/10 (we use a conservative threshold) is acceptable if it settles by the next morning and isn't trending up week to week.

Source: Thomeé, Phys Ther 1997; Silbernagel et al., Am J Sports Med 2007

E42 (grade A (statement)). AHA scientific statement (2023): resistance training is recommended for adults with and without cardiovascular disease. It lowers blood pressure and improves glucose control and function. Avoid breath-holding (Valsalva). People with CVD should get individualized clearance.

Source: Paluch et al., Circulation 2024 — <https://www.ahajournals.org/doi/10.1161/CIR.0000000000001189>

E43 (grade A (guideline)). Pre-exercise screening (ACSM 2015): anyone with symptoms of cardiovascular, metabolic or renal disease (chest pain, unusual breathlessness, fainting) should get medical clearance before starting. Otherwise, light-to-moderate exercise can begin and progress.

Source: Riebe et al., Med Sci Sports Exerc 2015 (known literature)

E59 (grade A (Cochrane, low certainty)). Exercise for hand osteoarthritis (Cochrane): 7 trials, 534 people, mostly women. After a hand-exercise programme, pain was 0.5 points lower (0–10), function 2.2 points better (0–36) and finger stiffness 0.7 points lower (0–10). Small effects, low or very low certainty, not sustained at medium- and long-term follow-up. The few adverse events were more finger-joint inflammation and hand pain. Say "may help a little with stiffness and hand use", never "fixes arthritis".

Source: Østerås et al., Cochrane 2017 — opened https://www.cochrane.org/CD010388/MUSKEL_exercise-hand-osteoarthritis